

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 574

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dr. Barbara Alfreda Duncan-Cody of Millington.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Dr. Barbara Alfreda Duncan-Cody of Millington; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Barbara Alfreda Duncan-Cody was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on April 25, 1946, Dr. Duncan-Cody was a proud member of the Manassas High School Class of 1964; she completed her undergraduate studies at Knoxville College and went on to earn her Doctor of Medicine degree from Meharry Medical College School of Medicine in 1980; and

WHEREAS, with more than forty-five years of professional experience, Dr. Duncan-Cody served as a physician, specializing in obstetrics and gynecology, in which position she earned the respect and admiration of her peers and community alike for the exemplary quality of her work; and

WHEREAS, a leader in her profession, Dr. Barbara Duncan-Cody was the sole proprietor of her practice, Duncan-Cody Medical Group, and the first Black female OB/GYN to open a private practice in Memphis; she took her much-deserved retirement from the medical profession in June 2025; and

WHEREAS, she was affiliated with Methodist Hospitals of Memphis, the Medical Auxiliary, and the Bluff City Medical Society, working alongside several doctors and specialists to ensure comprehensive care of her patients; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Duncan-Cody served her community in numerous capacities, including as a member of Delta Theta Sigma Sorority, Inc., and the Memphis Chapter of Links, Inc., and as a charter member of Jack & Jill of America, Inc., and the Memphis Chapter of The Society, Inc.; and

WHEREAS, additionally, she served as a member of the Shelby County 911 Board and the Methodist Healthcare Foundation Board of Directors, and she was featured in *The Commercial Appeal* and *Grace* magazines; and

WHEREAS, a beloved wife, mother, grandmother, and friend, Dr. Duncan-Cody was wholly devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish her memory are her husband of fifty-seven years, Attorney Homer Lee Cody; her children, Justin Ryan Cody and Rachel Joann Cody (Darrell) Alexander; and her grandchildren, Laila, Rome, and Darrell; and

WHEREAS, committed to her faith, Dr. Duncan-Cody was a lifelong member of Trinity Christian Methodist Episcopal Church in Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Duncan-Cody leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Barbara Duncan-Cody served her profession and her community with kindness and distinction, touching the lives of countless individuals and families, and it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Dr. Barbara Alfreda

Duncan-Cody, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Dr. Duncan-Cody.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.